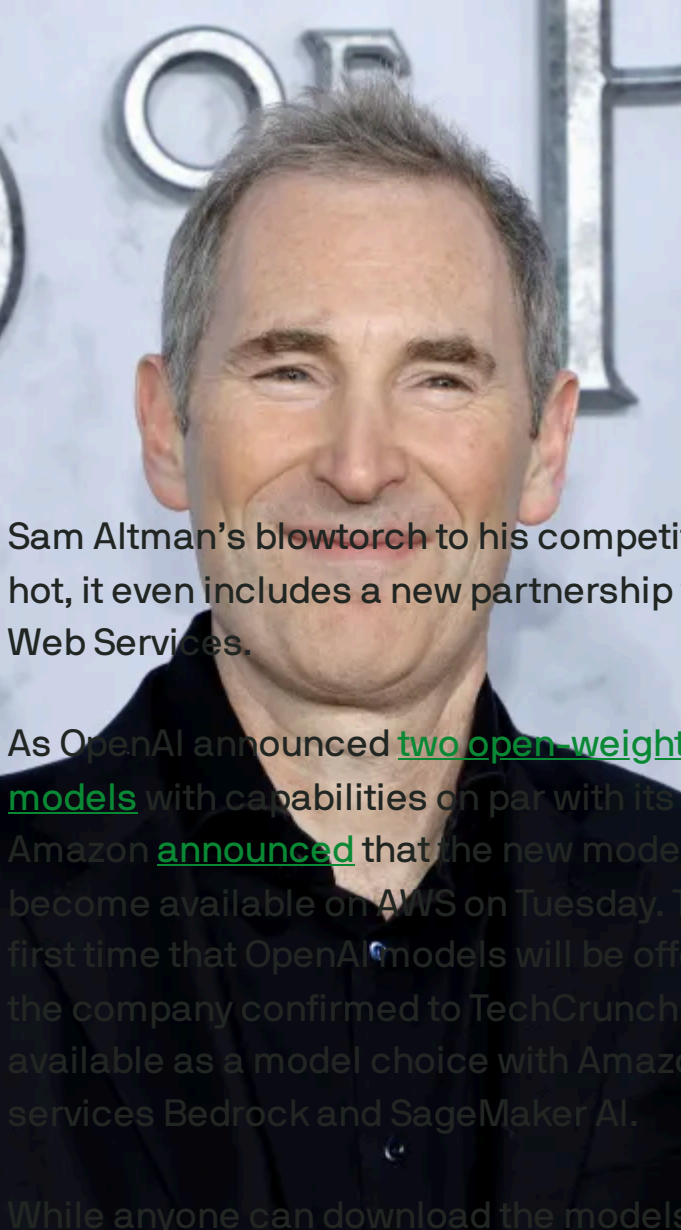


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AI



For the first time, OpenAI
models are available on
AWS



Julie Bort — 1:06 PM PDT · August 5, 2025

Sam Altman's blowtorch to his competitors is so hot, it even includes a new partnership with Amazon Web Services.

As OpenAI announced [two open-weight reasoning models](#) with capabilities on par with its o-series, Amazon [announced](#) that the new models would become available on AWS on Tuesday. This is the first time that OpenAI models will be offered by AWS, the company confirmed to TechCrunch. They will be available as a model choice with Amazon AI services Bedrock and SageMaker AI.

While anyone can download the models via Hugging Face, Amazon is offering these models with OpenAI's full knowledge and approval, as Dmitry Pimenov, the model maker's product lead, indicated in the announcement. A spokesperson described the offering as similar to how Amazon offered open model DeepSeek-R1 earlier this year.

This is a juicy competitive move for both companies. For AWS, it finally puts the cloud giant in the same sentence as the biggest model maker, OpenAI.

Until now, AWS has best been known as a major host and a [financial backer](#) of Anthropic's Claude, one of OpenAI's biggest competitors. AWS offers Claude, along with other models from makers such as Cohere, [DeepSeek](#), Meta, and [Mistral](#), as well as its own home-grown ones in its AI services. Specifically, Bedrock allows AWS customers to build and host generative AI apps using models of

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their choice. SageMaker, on the other hand, allows AWS customers to train, or even build, their own AI models largely for analytics uses.

While AWS's ultimate rival, Microsoft, hasn't [had a lock on OpenAI models since January](#), Azure is still OpenAI's most significant cloud partner to date. OpenAI even announced that Microsoft is offering versions of these two new models, too, optimized for Windows devices.

Watching Microsoft win an increasing amount of cloud business with OpenAI has been a public pain in Amazon CEO Andy Jassy's neck. Just last week during [Amazon's quarterly earnings call](#), Jassy was pounded with questions from Wall Street analysts about how the company was losing ground in AI to competitors, particularly Microsoft.

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For instance, JPMorgan analyst Doug Anmuth asked Jassy to explain “significantly faster cloud growth among the number two and number three players in the space,” referring to Microsoft and Google. Later,

Morgan Stanley analyst Brian Nowak told Jassy that Wall Street thinks “AWS is falling behind in GenAI with concerns about share loss, peers, etc.”

Jassy responded with a minutes-long diatribe that included this barb at Redmond: “I think the second player is about 65% of the size of the AWS.”

Meanwhile, another AWS competitor, Oracle, [reported that it signed a \\$30 billion a year deal with OpenAI](#) to offer data center services. This means that OpenAI plans to pay Oracle more each year than all of its other cloud services customers combined. Until now, AWS had been left out of any OpenAI-related glory.

As for how such a move with AWS benefits OpenAI: The AI provider’s relationship with Microsoft [is notoriously strained](#), as the two are [reportedly renegotiating their long-term partnership](#) deal. What better way for OpenAI to strengthen its position than to cozy up the biggest cloud provider, even if, initially, on a small scale?

In addition, this partnership allows swaths of AWS enterprise customers to easily experiment with using OpenAI models with their hosted AI apps.

Meanwhile Altman gets to undercut Meta’s Mark Zuckerberg with this move as well. As OpenAI releases these two high-performing models under an Apache 2.0 open source license, Meta recently admitted that [it probably won’t continue to open source all of its upcoming “superintelligence” models](#).

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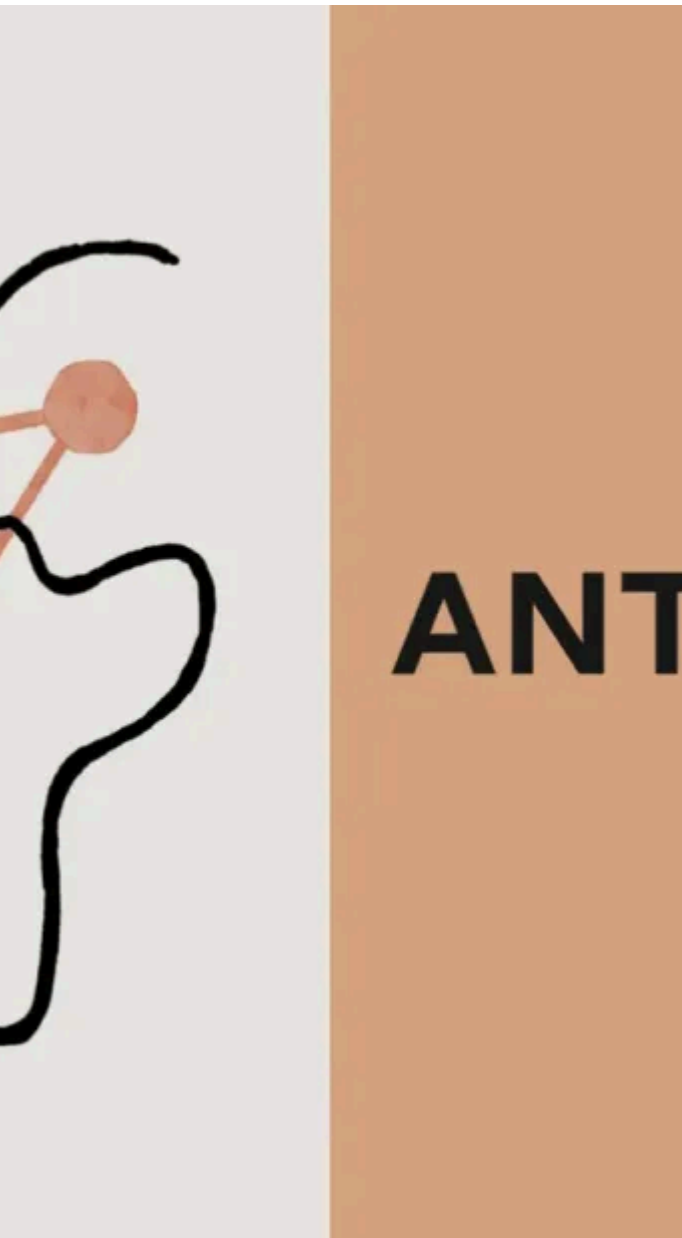


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AI

Amazon to invest up to \$4 billion in AI startup Anthropic

Manish Singh — 12:10 AM PDT · September 25, 2023

IMAGE CREDITS: ANTHROPIC

Amazon has agreed to invest up to \$4 billion in the AI startup Anthropic, the two firms said, as the e-commerce group steps up its rivalry against Microsoft, Meta, Google and Nvidia in the fast-

growing sector that many technologists believe could be the next great frontier.

The e-commerce group said it will initially invest \$1.25 billion for a minority stake in Anthropic, which like Google’s Bard and Microsoft-backed OpenAI also operates an AI-powered, text analyzing chatbot. As part of the deal, Amazon said it has an option to increase its investment in Anthropic to a total of \$4 billion.

TechCrunch reported exclusively earlier this year that Anthropic, which also counts Google as an investor, [plans to raise as much as \\$5 billion](#) over the next two years. Anthropic, which earlier this month launched its first [consumer-facing premium subscription plan](#) of chatbot Claude 2, plans to build a “frontier model” — tentatively called “Claude-Next” — that is 10 times more capable than today’s most powerful AI, according to a 2023 investor deck TechCrunch obtained earlier this year.

But this development, the startup cautioned, will require a billion dollars in spending over the next 18 months. (Microsoft has invested [as much as \\$11 billion in OpenAI](#) over the years.)

In Amazon, Anthropic has found a deep-pocketed strategic investor that can also provide it with compute power to build future AI models and then find and help sell the offerings to scores of cloud customers.

As part of the investment agreement, Anthropic will use Amazon’s cloud giant AWS as a primary cloud provider for mission-critical workloads, including safety research and future foundation model development, the e-commerce group said. Anthropic will additionally use AWS Trainium and Inferentia chips to build, train and deploy its future foundation models. (Anthropic has been a customer of AWS since 2021.)

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Amazon believes it can help “improve many customer experiences, short and long-term, through our deeper collaboration” with Anthropic, said Andy Jassy, Amazon chief executive, in a statement.

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“Customers are quite excited about Amazon Bedrock, AWS’s new managed service that enables companies to use various foundation models to build generative AI applications on top of, as well as AWS Trainium, AWS’s AI training chip, and our collaboration with Anthropic should help customers get even more value from these two capabilities.”

Anthropic — which also counts Spark Capital, Salesforce, Sound Ventures, Menlo Ventures and Zoom among its backers — has raised a total of \$2.7 billion to date. The startup was valued at about \$5 billion in May this year when it [secured \\$450 million](#) in a funding round. It didn’t say how Amazon valued Anthropic in the new investment.

The deal with Anthropic allows Amazon, which is [increasingly flexing its own muscles around AI](#), to build a bulkier war chest in the frantically fast-growing industry.

Market interest in AI has increased dramatically

Share of companies mentioning AI on Russell 3000 earnings calls

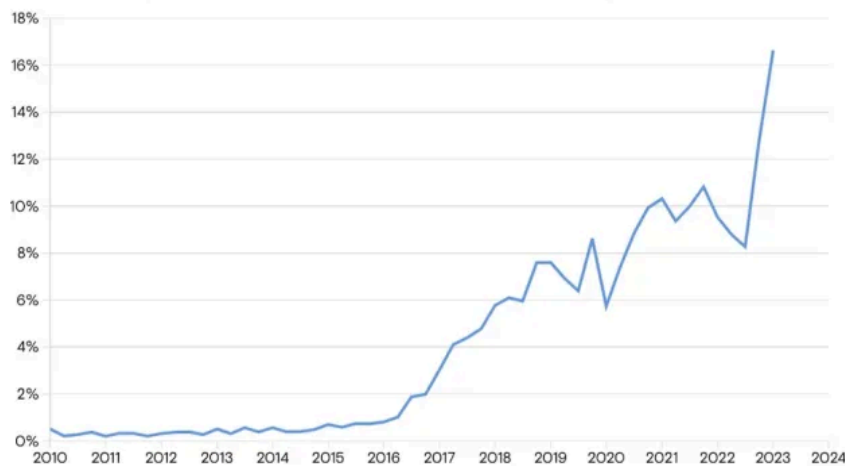


IMAGE AND DATA: GOLDMAN SACHS

Anthropic chief executive and co-founder Dario Amodei told the TechCrunch Disrupt audience last week that he [doesn't see any barriers on the horizon](#) for his company's key technology.

“The last 10 years, there's been this remarkable increase in the scale that we've used to train neural nets and we keep scaling them up, and they keep working better and better,” he said last week.

“That's the basis of my feeling that what we're going to see in the next 2, 3, 4 years... what we see today is going to pale in comparison to that.”

Anthropic has made a “long-term” commitment to provide AWS customers around the world with access to future generations of its foundation models via Amazon Bedrock, AWS's fully managed service that provides secure access to the industry's top foundation models. In addition, Anthropic will provide AWS customers with early access to unique features for model customization and fine-tuning capabilities.

“Training state-of-the-art models requires extensive resources including compute power and

research programs. Amazon’s investment and supply of AWS Trainium and Inferentia technology will ensure we’re equipped to continue advancing the frontier of AI safety and research,” said Anthropic in a statement. “We look forward to working closely with Amazon to responsibly scale adoption of Claude and deliver safe AI cloud technologies to organizations around the world.”

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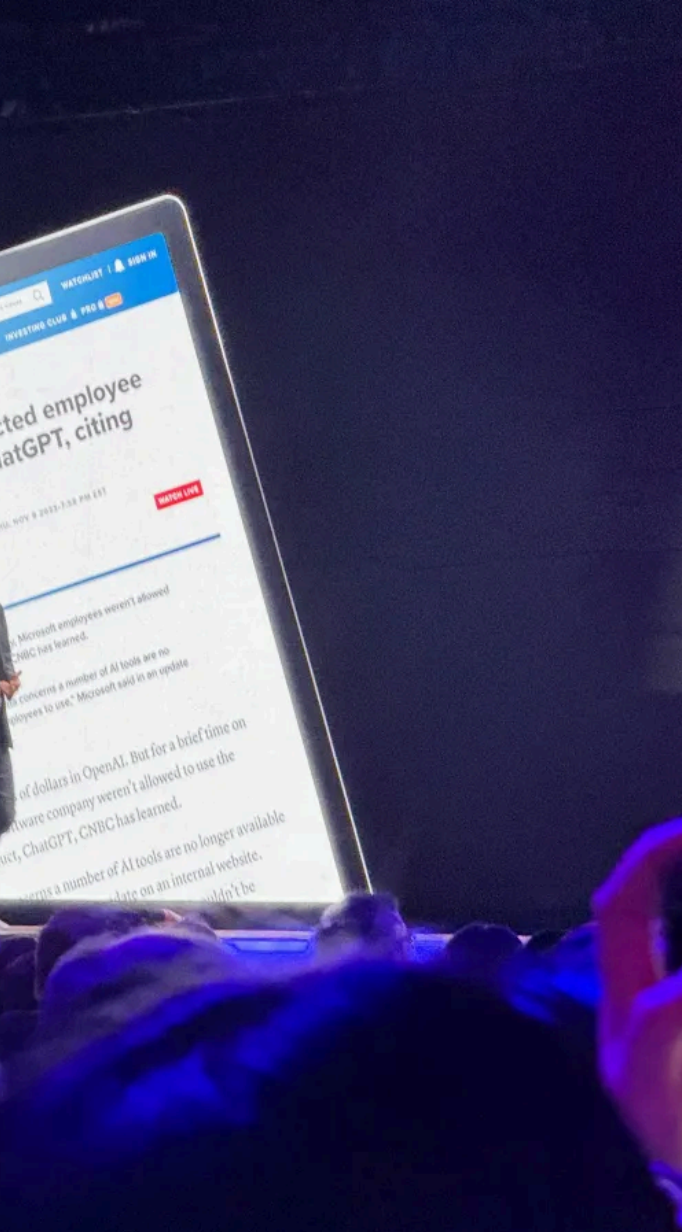
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Manish Singh is a senior reporter at TechCrunch, covering India’s startup scene and venture capital investments. He...

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AWS takes the cheap shots

Frederic Lardinois — 11:44 AM PST · November 28, 2023

The rise of generative AI opens up a massive new market for the large cloud providers, but it's also a bit of a reset. Unlike the rise of containers, for example, generative AI is an entirely new market. Some players who have long lagged behind in the overall cloud market — like Google — are explicitly betting on this to change their fortunes. But for AWS, that means it's now in a position where it potentially has to defend its lead, something the company isn't used to and something that became quite clear in AWS CEO Adam Selipsky's re:Invent keynote today.

AWS used to make the occasional fun of Oracle during its early keynotes. Today, during what was a relatively sedate affair by [AWS re:Invent](#) keynote

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like that in France and a fire broke out there, the zone would've been down. At best, that was a thinly veiled reference to Google's [multi-week outage](#) in its Paris data center earlier this year. AWS, of course, has also had its share of outages — just like every other cloud provider. Though to be fair, Google's outage was excessive.



IMAGE CREDITS: FREDERIC LARDINOIS/TECHCRUNCH

“Others would have you think that all clouds are the same, but that’s just not true,” he said. “I mean, imagine if you had a region supported by a single data center, or if you thought your provider had multiple AZs in France, for example, and you thought were resilient, but it turned out that they are actually in the same location. I mean, one incident like a water leak followed by a fire could take down an entire region for days.”

Next, in launching its new Graviton chips, Selipsky also stressed that “we’re now on our fourth generation in just five years. Other cloud providers

have not even delivered on their first server processors yet.”

But it is generative AI where Amazon is most vulnerable right now. For the first time in a long time, it doesn’t have a first-mover advantage in the cloud. Unsurprisingly, the recent OpenAI drama provided plenty of material for AWS’ CEO to take swipes at the competition, including the news that Microsoft briefly stopped its employees from using OpenAI’s ChatGPT because of security concerns.

“You won’t actually use any of this in a serious way if it isn’t secure and private,” Selipsky said. “When I think about it, I can’t conceive of other cloud providers trying to offer general AI services or customers using gen AI applications. They’re not confident in their models and that their data is secure.”

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And while Microsoft Azure is offering access to dozens of proprietary and open source models, too, Selipsky tried to capitalize on the fact that the

company is so closely linked with OpenAI: “Things are moving so fast — and in that type of environment, the ability to adapt is the most valuable capability that you can have. There is not going to be one model to rule them all. And there’s certainly not going to be one company providing the models that everybody uses. So you don’t want a cloud provider who’s beholden primarily to one model provider.”



IMAGE CREDITS: FREDERIC LARDINOIS/TECHCRUNCH

During the keynote, Selipsky brought Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei out onstage to talk about the close partnership between the two companies and noted how AWS users will get exclusive early access to some features in Anthropic’s Claude model. AWS also plans to [invest up to \\$4 billion in Anthropic](#), making that look a bit like the relationship between Microsoft and OpenAI. But I guess that depends on your perspective.

Talking about CodeWhisperer, Amazon’s competitor to GitHub’s significantly more successful Copilot, AWS’ CEO noted that “other providers who have launched tools, they’ve launched them without data privacy and security capabilities that virtually every enterprise requires.”

I think AWS’ competitors would take issue with that.

Thing is, AI is causing businesses to rethink their cloud strategies. Microsoft’s close relationship to

OpenAI gave it an early advantage. Google has long had a reputation in the world of AI and machine learning in general. With tools like SageMaker, Bedrock and now its Q assistant, AWS is arguably on equal footing, but it's not in its natural element — and its rhetoric shows that.

[Amazon to invest up to \\$4 billion in AI startup Anthropic](#)



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 **Frederic Lardinois**
Editor |    

Frederic was with TechCrunch from 2012 through 2025. He also founded SiliconFilter and wrote for ReadWriteWeb...

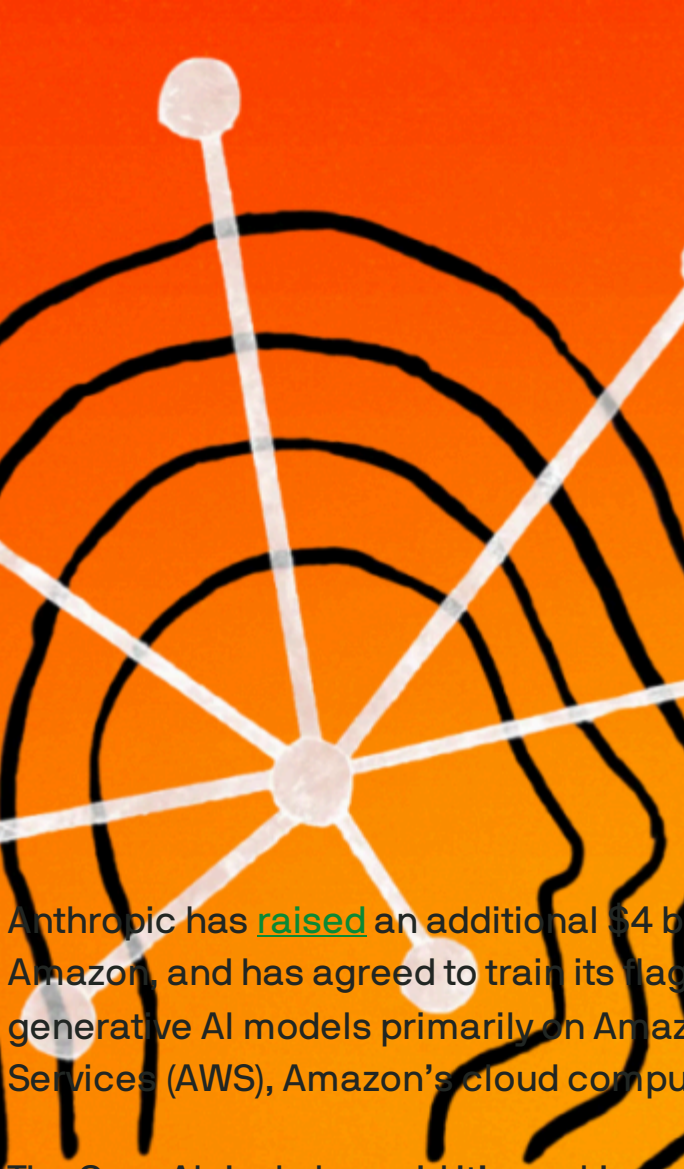
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Anthropic raises another \$4B from Amazon, makes AWS its ‘primary’ training partner

Kyle Wiggers — 6:10 AM PST · November 22, 2024



Anthropic has [raised](#) an additional \$4 billion from Amazon, and has agreed to train its flagship generative AI models primarily on Amazon Web Services (AWS), Amazon’s cloud computing division.

The OpenAI rival also said it’s working with Annapurna Labs, AWS’ chipmaking division, to develop future generations of [Trainium](#) accelerators, AWS’ custom-built chips for training AI models.

IMAGE CREDITS: ANTHROPIC

“Our engineers work closely with Annapurna’s chip design team to extract maximum computational efficiency from the hardware, which we plan to leverage to train our most advanced foundation models,” Anthropic wrote in a blog post. “Together with AWS, we’re laying the technological foundation — from silicon to software — that will power the next generation of AI research and development.”

In its own [post](#), Amazon clarified that Anthropic will use Trainium — including the current version of Trainium, [Trainium2](#) — to train its upcoming models. The AI startup would use [Inferentia](#), Amazon’s in-

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house chip meant to accelerate model running and serving, to deploy those models, Amazon said.

“By collaborating with Anthropic on the development of our custom Trainium chips, we’ll keep pushing the boundaries of what customers can achieve with generative AI technologies,” AWS CEO Matt Garman said in a statement. “We’ve been impressed by Anthropic’s pace of innovation and commitment to responsible development of generative AI, and look forward to deepening our collaboration.”

This new cash infusion brings Amazon’s total investment in Anthropic to \$8 billion while maintaining the tech giant’s position as a minority investor, Anthropic said. To date, Anthropic has raised \$13.7 billion in venture capital, [according](#) to Crunchbase.

The Information [reported](#) earlier this month that Amazon was in talks to invest billions in Anthropic, its first financial pledge in the company after a \$4 billion [deal](#) last year. That deal was split into two separate tranches, a \$1.25 billion first installment last September, and a \$2.75 billion extension in March.

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The new investment is reportedly structured similarly to the last one, but with a twist: Amazon insisted that Anthropic use Amazon-developed silicon hosted on AWS to train its AI.

Anthropic is said to prefer Nvidia chips, but the money may have been too good to pass up. Early this year, Anthropic [reportedly](#) projected it would burn through more than \$2.7 billion in 2024 as it trained and scaled up its AI products. Anthropic has been discussing raising new funding at a \$40 billion valuation for several months, [per](#) The Information. No doubt, the pressure was on to clinch something soon.

Anthropic's co-founder and CEO Dario Amodei noted that its work with AWS has greatly expanded over the past year. Through [Amazon Bedrock](#), AWS' platform for hosting and fine-tuning generative models, Anthropic's Claude family of models are being used by "tens of thousands" of customers, Amodei said.

"This has been a year of breakout growth for Claude, and our collaboration with Amazon has been instrumental in bringing Claude's capabilities to millions of end users across tens of thousands of customers on Amazon Bedrock," he said in a press release. "We're looking forward to working with Amazon to train and power our most advanced AI models using AWS Trainium, and helping to unlock the full potential of their technology."

Recently, Anthropic teamed up with AWS and Palantir to [provide](#) U.S. intelligence and defense agencies access to Claude. Amazon said that going

forward, AWS customers will get early access to the ability to fine-tune new Claude models on their data.

Beyond AWS, Amazon is said to be working with Anthropic to revamp the former's consumer products. And, the tech giant is reportedly set to [replace](#) the in-house models powering Alexa, its virtual assistant, with Anthropic's after encountering technical challenges.

The collaboration — and investments — have attracted regulatory scrutiny.

The FTC earlier this year sent a letter to Amazon, as well as Microsoft and Google, [requiring](#) the companies to explain the impacts their investments in startups such as Anthropic have on the competitive landscape of generative AI. Google has also [invested](#) in Anthropic, pouring \$2 billion into the company late last October for a 10% stake, while Microsoft is a major OpenAI backer.

The U.K.'s competition regulator, the Competition and Markets Authority, also opened several inquiries into big tech tie-ups with AI firms. But the regulator [recently](#) okayed Alphabet's partnership and investment in Anthropic; it had given the green light to Amazon's deal last year.

Anthropic continues to maintain pace with other frontier AI labs, releasing new functionality like [Computer Use](#), which lets the company's current best model, Claude 3.5 Sonnet, perform tasks on a PC autonomously.

The company has also faced its fair share of setbacks. The company [unexpectedly](#) hiked the price of one of its models this month, and it has delayed the launch of its long-awaited, next-gen model, Claude 3.5 Opus.

In a bid to boost revenue, Anthropic has shifted some of its focus to releasing new tools and

subscription plans, including a [desktop client](#), [enterprise](#) and “[team](#)” tiers, and [mobile apps](#). It has also [opened offices](#) in Europe and made high-profile hires, including Instagram co-founder [Mike Krieger](#), OpenAI co-founder [Durk Kingma](#), and ex-OpenAI safety researcher [Jan Leike](#).

Anthropic was co-launched in 2021 by Amodei, who was once VP of research at OpenAI and [reportedly](#) split with the firm after disagreements over the roadmap. Amodei brought along a number of ex-OpenAI employees to start Anthropic, including OpenAI’s former policy lead, Jack Clark.

Anthropic often attempts to position itself as more safety-focused than OpenAI.

Correction: This story was corrected to remove a reference to Gabor Cselle, who was hired by OpenAI, and not Anthropic.

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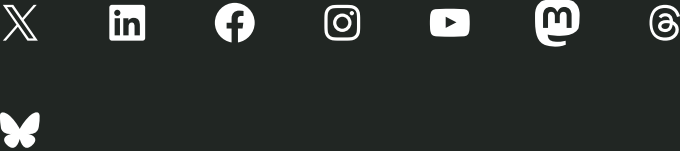
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